

Board of Library Trustees

Library Director Amanda Hirst

Library IT Specialist

Kaden Casanave

Business Manager Shirley Yang

Facilities Staff
Locksley Carroll
Patricia Cartagena-Perez
Frank Hickey
Felix Pena

Assistant Director for Administration Danielle Savin

Putterham Branch Supervisor Ginger O'Day

LA III
Sebastian Sulser

LA II
Charlotte Ryan

PT Lib
Marcy Maiorana

PT LA
Jackie Corcoran
Rosa Nicolazzo
Dora Souroufis
Henry Bulkeley

PT Page
Jessica Becker

Executive Assistant to Library Director Courtney Hesslein

Brookline Village Head of Collection Services Ryan Brennan

Lib II
Vacant

Lib I
Jingting Long

LA III
Vacant

LA II
Percival Salazar

Brookline Village Head of Circulation Sar Durkin

LA II
Roberta Blumenthal
Sarah Collier
Celia Dennis
Roberto Lauro-Priestly

PT LA
Jacquelyn Deschidn
Mac Miller
Karen O'Keefe
Adrian Ortega
Kevin Tang
Yixuan Wu

Brookline Village Head of Reference Jess Steytler

Lib II
Vacant
Lily Weitzman

Lib I
Bryan Kreusch
Jackson Mathews
Nina Rabkina
Jared Walske

PT LA
Alana Kirby
Eric Maki

Brookline Village Head of Youth Services Julie Kellndorfer

Lib II
Robin Brenner

Lib I
Macy Davis
Abbey Stephens

LA III
Amy Diamond
Sasha Zeidenberg

PT LA
Kaelan Heston
Silvia Lee
Alexa Salvato
Maryanne Shaughnessy
Marie Wheeler
Zitong Ye
Carrie Zuttermeister

PT Page
Ariel Ervin

Coolidge Corner Branch Supervisor Vacant

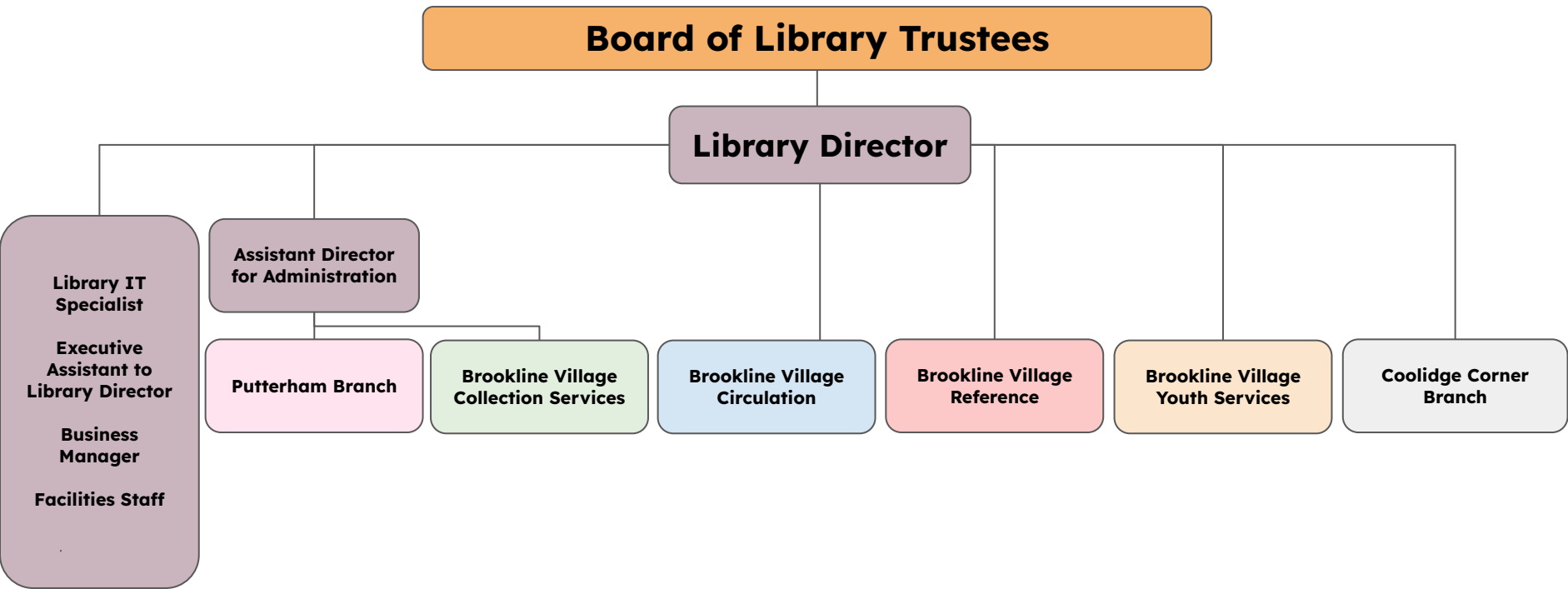
Lib II
Elissa Martel
Chloe Feuerstein

Lib I
Leah Ellenbogen

LA II
Brenda Craig
Jeanne Val
Kenny Yim

PT LA
Maya Freed-Barlow
Samantha Friedman
Connor Pahl
Lily Perrella Lewellen
Connie Ling
Catherine Saines
Khara Whitney-Marsh

PT Page
Mariah Colbert
Winnie Huie
Tom Golden
River Tiech
James Yee





THE PUBLIC LIBRARY OF BROOKLINE

Where stories begin.

The Board of Library Trustees

Meeting: Library Trustees

Date: Tuesday, March 12, 2024

Time: 6:15 PM

Location: Hybrid

In-person: Trustees Room, Public Library of Brookline, 361 Washington Street, 02445

Virtual: Zoom

- **Zoom Registration:**

<https://brooklinema.zoomgov.com/meeting/register/vJlsc-mgqD4vEnqqgmKZTxyAra3iTqF0lcQ>

- I. Comments from the Chair
- II. Comments from the Public (3 minute limit)
- III. Secretary's Report
 - A. Minutes
 - B. Correspondence
 - C. Other items
- IV. Treasurer's Report
 - A. Other
- V. Library Director's Report
 - A. Statistical
 - B. Financial
- VI. Trustee Committee Reports
 - A. Other
- VII. Old Business
 - A. Staff Retention - Salary Study



THE PUBLIC LIBRARY OF BROOKLINE

Where stories begin.

VIII. New Business

A. Resident patron type

IX. Remarks for the Good of the Order

X. Adjourn

If you plan to make a motion or amend the minutes, please give a written copy to the Trustee Secretary.

Please see link to documents relevant to this meeting:

<https://www.brooklinema.gov/DocumentCenter/Index/5209>

Please contact Library Administration (brkadmin@minlib.net / 617-730-2360) with questions about this meeting.

The Public Library of Brookline

Trustees Report February 2024

MLN top-five print circulation **(all branches)**

Cambridge: 114,992 (+8.42%)

Newton: 102,097 (+3.74%)

Brookline: 66,585 (+4.66%)

Arlington: 64,669 (+7.12%)

Lexington: 60,668 (+3.54%)

BRK branch print circulation

Brookline Village: 34,276 (+10.6%)

Coolidge Corner: 20,897 (-3.42%)

Putterham: 11,142 (+3.81%)

Total: 66,585 (+4.66%)

BRK print + digital circulation

OverDrive: 21,118 (+20.19%)

Hoopla: 3,211 (-5.56%)

Kanopy: 1,913 (+37.72%)

Print: 66,585 (+4.66%)

Total: 92,827 (+7.96%)

Turnover

Brookline Village: 2.47 (-1.2%)

Coolidge Corner: 3.69 (-3.91%)

Putterham: 3.56 (-9.41%)

New Library Cards

Brookline Village: 157

Coolidge Corner: 121

Putterham: 24

Attendance

Brookline Village: 23,888

(+19.43%)

Coolidge Corner: 15,618

(+19.08%)

Putterham: 5,070 (+9.48%)

Total: 44,576 (+18.09%)

Computer sessions (all **locations)**

Desktop (Useful/Chromebox): not
available

Wifi: not available

Pages printed: not available

Title of Motion: Covering of the Meeting 6:17pm

Trustee	Yay	Nay	Abstain	Absent
Burstein	x			
Chanyasulkit	x			
Fredkin				x
Goleman				x
Hung	x			
Livingston				x
Lohe	x			
Margolis	x			
Martin-Page	x			
Vanderkay	x			
Vogt	x			
Zelka				x

Director's Report, March, 2024

News & Noteworthy

- **Putterham:** Learn Origami program has been growing and had its highest number of attendees at the end of last month with 25 enthusiastic participants of all ages!
- **Brookline Village:** Artwork at the main library was featured in [The Cypress](#)
- **All Locations:** Patrons of all ages have been participating in our passive "love letters to the library" activity this February. Staff members have received shout-outs, and the messages expressing appreciation for our services have been making us smile all month. The activity has been featured on our social media and is one of our most liked posts this month!
- **All Locations:** Lunar New Year was a huge success, with events for both kids and adults throughout the month at all three locations. Special shoutout to Elissa, Jingting, Silvia, Yixuan, Winnie, and Zitong for their hard work in planning and running all the events! BIG filmed the Lion Dance at the Coolidge Corner Library and it is available here: <https://youtu.be/CY7lhZFTHNQ?feature=shared>
- **All Locations:** February vacation week was a hit at all three locations! Programs for kids like a Matt Heaton concert, STEAM show from Talewise, and Puppet Showplace Theater all were great and had a great attendance.

ARPA Round 1: Technology Infrastructure and Round 2: Bookmobile

- Round 1: nothing new to report
- Round 2: still talking with vendors

Automated Materials Handling System (Sorter)

Brookline Village: Project moving forward, estimated install date is July 23rd.

Buildings and Grounds

- All locations will be closed on Sunday, March 31st.

Budget

FY24: On budget

FY25: Date with the Advisory Committee has been tentatively scheduled as Thursday, March 15th.

Personnel

See Position Control and Org Chart Documents in the Director's Report File Folder.

- Resignations
 - Lily Weitzman - Reference

Freedom of Information Act Requests & Court Orders

The Public Library of Brookline had no FOIA Requests since the last meeting.

The Public Library of Brookline has not been served with any court orders since the last meeting.

Minutes of the Board of Library Trustees, Public Library of Brookline

A virtual meeting of the Trustees of the Public Library was convened on Tuesday, February 13, 2023, at 6:17 PM.

Present: Burstein; Chanyasulkit; Goleman; Hung; Lohe; Margolis; Martin-Page; Vanderkay; Vogt

Absent: Fredkin; Livingston; Zelkha

Also present: Library Director, A. Hirst; Assistant Director to Administration, D. Savin, Executive Assistant to the Library Director, C. Hesslein

Trustees voted to convene the meeting.

All votes were conducted by roll call vote.

I. Comments from the Chair

A. Burstein provides brief comments about his health

II. Comments from the Public (5 minute limit)

A. No comments from the public

III. Welcome Chloe Feuerstein - Assistant Branch Supervisor, Coolidge Corner

A. This agenda item will be moved to the next Trustees meeting

IV. Secretary's Report

A. Minutes

1. Martin-Page notes that an update was made to January's minutes; clarifies that Anne was in service for 46 years, not only 27
2. Lohe motions to approve the updated minutes; Margolis seconds
3. Trustees unanimously vote to approve minutes

B. Correspondence

1. Martin-Page informs Trustees that the correspondence subfolder on the Google Drive has two letters uploaded

C. Other items

1. No other items to discuss

V. Treasurer's Report

A. Other

1. Nothing to report; Lohe asks if anyone has questions on the half-year budget; no questions for Lohe

VI. Library Director's Report

A. Statistical

1. Hirst explains that she will meet with the Select Board on Tuesday, March 19 to discuss next year's budget, the Library's long- and short-term goals, and how the Library's goals align with the Select Board's goals
2. Hirst submitted FY25 goals, which are largely the same as FY24's goals
3. Library is operating business as usual after recent onboarding of new staff

B. Financial

1. No discussion and no questions from Trustees

VII. Trustee Committee Reports

A. Staff Appreciation

1. Annual party was held on February 2; went well; group photo of attendees is in the February Google Drive folder

B. Other

1. Written report in Drive from Friends meeting
2. Trustee Development Committee: work ongoing on new trustee orientation plan

VIII. Old Business

A. Staff Retention

1. Margolis proposes that we consider an anonymous survey for staff to understand staff sentiments, which would include a question about likelihood of staying at PLB and for how long; explains that it would be phase one of a broader project that follows up on the survey and shows Trustee's ongoing fact-finding attempt to continue to inform actions / solutions; Margolis reminds Trustees that they are not managers of the library
2. Vogt inquires about how to get information about salary comparisons
 - a) Hirst explains that Town is in process of completing a compensation study but only for Department / Division heads; Hirst reminds Trustees that they can fund a salary study
 - b) Margolis offers that Trustees should be more involved in non-salary items but indicates his interest in Trustees funding this kind of study; Burstein indicates he will look into what the Massachusetts Board of Library Commissioners suggests / offers
3. Lohe asks Hirst about the degree to which Library salaries are linked to other Town roles; Hirst answers that they are distinct

IX. New Business

A. Board and Commission Procedures

1. Burstein explains that the Select Board is trying to get more updates from Boards they appoint; since the Library Trustees are not appointed and have different reporting structure, Burstein will talk with Select Board Chair to understand what they would like to see / receive from the Library Trustees' annual report; Burstein offers that this presents another

opportunity for the Trustees to advocate for the Library and the Library's budget

2. Martin-Page adds to Zoom chat the weblink to Massachusetts conflict of interest summary; asks for roll call to be completed to indicate that each Trustee has received the link; all present Trustees indicate receipt; will need to share link with 3 absent Trustees at the next meeting

X. Remarks for the Good of the Order

- A. Burstein informs Board that the four trustees with terms expiring this year have indicated their interest in being re-elected; thanks them for their commitment to serving again
- B. Burstein reminds Board of DEI Committee's purpose, which is to implement changes based on the Carter study; explains that he made himself Chair to ensure this work would move forward, but has realized that the Chair of the Board shouldn't chair a second committee; puts out call to whole Board for someone to chair the DEI Committee
- C. Burstein also appointing a Nominations Committee; Kristin Hung will chair the Committee with Judith Goleman; the purpose of this Committee is to find people who are interested in serving as officers of the Board
- D. Burstein explains that this is his 3rd year chairing the Board, has chaired the Board for a total of 5 years over the years; indicates that it is time for him to take break from chairing; is asking the Nominations Committee to identify a Trustee / Trustees who would be able and willing to serve as chair

XI. Adjourn

- A. Margolis moves to adjourn meeting; Chanyasulkit seconds
- B. Board unanimously votes to adjourn meeting

Meeting adjourned at 7:19 PM.

Minutes drafted by Courtney Hesslein

July 1, 2023 to June 30, 2024			
January 2024			
Balance	\$ 233,978.78	\$ 54,412.63	\$ 55,102.01
Income To Date	FY2023 YTD	January	FY2024 YTD
Book Sales/Merchandise	\$ 10,649.07	\$ 642.10	\$ 11,038.13
Dues	\$ 280.00		\$ 55.00
Donations: (Dues in excess of \$10.00)	\$ 5,920.00	\$ 5,260.00	\$ 7,266.45
Other Income		\$ 20.00	\$ 90.00
Total Income	\$ 16,849.07	\$ 5,922.10	\$ 18,449.58
Expenditures			
Copying/Printing/Postage	\$ (125.00)		
PO Box	\$ (216.00)		\$ (230.00)
Copying/Printing			
Supplies	\$ (22.15)		\$ (26.46)
Merchandise/Bags			
Book Sale Expenses			
Supplies			
Other			
Volunteers	\$ (275.00)	\$ (420.00)	\$ (420.00)
Membership/Conferences			
FY22 Expenditures	\$ (11,229.32)		
Bank Services			
Tax Filing Fees			\$ (134.90)
Valentine Lunch	\$ (1,031.52)		
Purchase CDs	\$ (150,000.00)		
Friends Meetings/Programs			\$ (116.60)
Donations to the Library			
Professional Development	\$ (4,061.11)	\$ (600.00)	\$ (7,170.96)
Craft Kits	\$ (754.22)		
Adult Programs	\$ (1,400.00)	\$ (210.71)	\$ (210.71)
Summer Reading	\$ (1,449.91)	\$ (128.22)	\$ (1,000.09)
Teen Programs	\$ (2,240.50)	\$ (373.25)	\$ (1,807.18)
Children & Youth	\$ (232.32)	\$ (374.37)	\$ (1,274.28)
Other (Book Club Snacks)	\$ (90.19)	\$ (25.00)	\$ (180.48)
Special Program	\$ (500.00)	\$ (3,101.17)	\$ (3,740.02)
TOTAL Expenditures	\$ (173,627.24)	\$ (5,232.72)	\$ (16,081.68)
Checking Account Balance	\$ 67,200.61	\$ 55,102.01	\$ 57,469.91

Money Market Balance	\$ 19,295.81	\$ 19,431.94	\$ 19,431.94
Certificates of Deposit	\$ 150,658.20	\$ 155,572.86	\$ 155,572.86
TOTALS	\$ 237,154.62	\$ 230,106.81	\$ 232,474.71
Money Market Balance FY24			\$ 19,346.08
July Interest		\$ 12.72	\$ 19,358.80
August Interest		\$ 14.80	\$ 19,373.60
September Interest		\$ 14.33	\$ 19,387.93
October Interest		\$ 14.82	\$ 19,402.75
November Interest		\$ 14.35	\$ 19,417.10
December Interest		\$ 14.84	\$ 19,431.94
January Interest		\$ 14.82	\$ 19,446.76
Feburary Interest			
March Interest			
April Interest			
May Interest			
June Interest			
Certificates of Deposit			\$ 152,361.50
July Interest		\$ 401.11	\$ 152,762.61
August Interest		\$ 415.56	\$ 153,178.17
September Interest		\$ 604.95	\$ 153,783.12
October Interest		\$ 587.76	\$ 154,370.88
November Interest		\$ 609.66	\$ 154,980.54
December Interest		\$ 592.32	\$ 155,572.86
January Interest		\$ 614.44	\$ 156,187.30
February Interest			
March Interest			
April Interest			
May Interest			
June Interest			
Budget for FY24 (July 1, 2023 - June 30, 2024)			
Donations to the library	Budgeted	Spent	Balance
Professional Development	\$ 20,000.00	\$ (7,170.96)	\$ 12,829.04
Adult Programs	\$ 6,000.00	\$ (210.71)	\$ 5,789.29
Summer Reading	\$ 6,000.00	\$ (1,000.09)	\$ 4,999.91
Teen Programs	\$ 3,000.00	\$ (1,807.18)	\$ 1,192.82
Childrens/Youth Services	\$ 2,000.00	\$ (1,274.28)	\$ 725.72

Special Programs	\$ 1,000.00	\$ (3,740.02)	\$ (2,740.02)
Book Group Snacks	\$ 500.00	\$ (155.48)	\$ 655.48
Valentine's Day Lunch for Staff	\$ 1,500.00		\$ 1,500.00
Copying/Printing/Postage	\$ 500.00	\$ (26.46)	\$ 473.54
Friends Meetings/Programs/Other	\$ 600.00	\$ (251.50)	\$ 348.50
Book Sale Expenses	\$ 500.00	\$ (64.90)	\$ 435.10
Brookline-Quezalguaque	\$ 2,500.00		\$ 2,500.00
	\$ 44,100.00	\$ (15,701.58)	\$ 28,709.38

Board Committee Report

COMMITTEE NAME: **Friends of the Brookline Public Library**

Meeting Date	February 26, 2024 via Zoom
Committee Members	Judith Vanderkay, Judy Goleman
Attendees	Pam Roberts, Carol Caro, Beverly Kargir, Paul Walsh, Susanna Stiefel, Judith Vanderkay, Amy Diamond (the new staff liaison), Amanda Hirst
Absent	Ellen Franco, Ellen Weiss, Rita Shon-Baker, Barbara Sisson, Dan Jacobs, Judy Goleman
Posted on Town Website? Yes ☒ No ☐	
Do you want to report at the next Bolt meeting? Yes ☐ No ☒	
Minutes: Carol presented the latest financial report, and informed the group that the CDs have been rolled over, as Amanda stated that those funds will not be needed for a while. She called for a vote to send \$2,500 to the library of our Sister City Quetzalguaque, which passed unanimously. She also is looking into Paypal to possibly get a lower rate than the 4% commission that Network for Good charges on donations. Amanda provided an update on the library activities. The MLA institutional membership has gone through and there's considerable staff interest. The automated materials handling system has been ordered and contractors have been contacted for installation. She is still working on procuring an electric bookmobile, and consulting with Watertown, which has done this. She described the budget process underway with the Town – the good news is that the budget for the library is increasing, unlike some other departments. Amy Diamond introduced herself as the new staff liaison to the Friends, and she described some recent programs for children and families. Carol asked whether Amanda is expecting employees to request professional development this year, and it turns out that the ALA conference will be in San Diego, which will likely inspire people (and would likely exhaust the remaining \$13K in the professional development budget). Amanda also looked into group memberships to the MLA, which would provide benefits to multiple employees. The Friends agreed to fund the \$600 group membership. Judy Goleman delivered an update on the last Trustees meeting. Michael Burstein will undergo eye surgery and Vice-chair Jon Margolis will be in charge if needed. The board voted to approve	

the siting of the bookmobile charging station on the right side of the driveway. The Trustees' staff party will be held February 2.

The Friends is/are planning the customary staff appreciation luncheon on Valentine's Day.

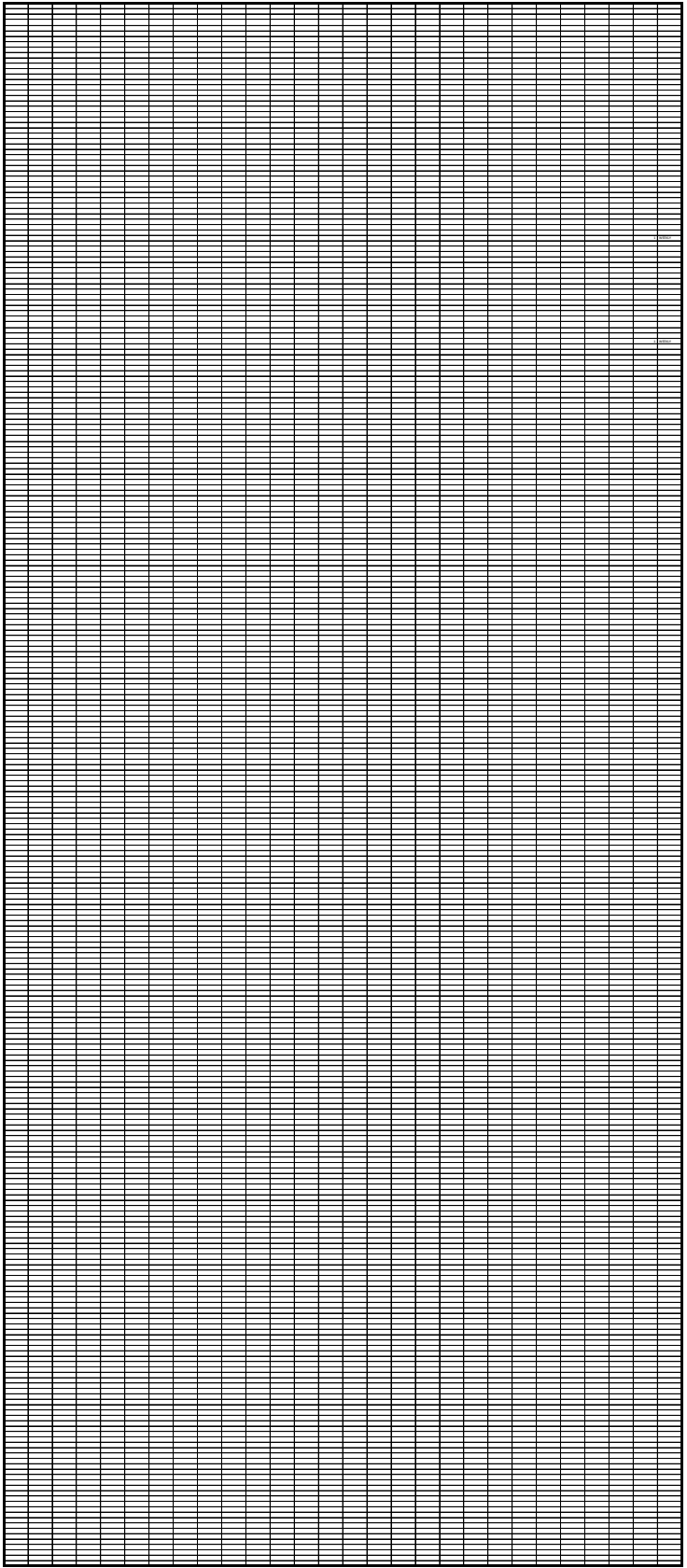
Next steps/discussion topics for board:

The next meeting will be in February, not sure of the exact date.

Total Municipal Appropriation		
\$	4,542,513.93	

Expenditures YTD		
\$ 2,890,678.40		

% of Budget Spent
63.64%





THE PUBLIC LIBRARY OF BROOKLINE

Where stories begin.

The Board of Library Trustees

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